



MSC World America — Solo Cruisers Group

April 24 – May 1, 2027 · Denise Sheets Ferguson, host

Ship: MSC World America · **Sailing from:** MSC Miami Cruise Terminal · **Cabin:** _____

A condensed Voyage Pack from [In the Wake](#) — the essentials in three pages. The full pack covers cabins, packing, budget, ship orientation, ports in depth, MSC's quirks, and the group rhythm.

Day by day

#	Date	Port	Hours ashore	Dock/Tender	Worth knowing
1	Sat Apr 24	PortMiami — embarkation	board 11:30 AM – 3:30 PM; depart ~5:00 PM	—	All-aboard 4 PM. Sailaway at the World Promenade (Deck 8 aft, Y-stern).
2	Sun Apr 25	Cruising at sea	—	—	Settling-in day. Possible Gala Evening; specialty dining slots open.
3	Mon Apr 26	Roatán, Honduras	~8:00 AM – 5:00 PM	dock at Coxen Hole (Port of Roatán)	West Bay Beach via taxi (~\$15–20 r/t) or snorkel the Mesoamerican Reef.
4	Tue Apr 27	Costa Maya, Mexico	~9:00 AM – 6:00 PM	dock	Easiest port: walk from ship to the pool complex, or Chacchoben ruins (~\$50 indep).
5	Wed Apr 28	Cozumel, Mexico	~9:00 AM – 7:00 PM	dock (Punta Langosta, Intl, or Puerta Maya)	Palancar Reef snorkel — <i>the</i> Western Caribbean dive. ~\$50 indep.
6	Thu Apr 29	Cruising at sea	—	—	Recovery day. Second Gala Evening likely. Eataly walk-up at lunch.
7	Fri Apr 30	Ocean Cay (Bahamas)	full day, possibly overnight	dock alongside	MSC's private island. Lighthouse evening show ONLY on overnight/late-departure calls — verify.
8	Sat May 1	PortMiami — debarkation	off by 10:00 AM	—	Uber to MIA ~\$30–45. Bayfront Park if killing time.

Possible Gala Evenings: typically the two sea-day evenings (Day 2 + Day 6). Smart-casual otherwise. **MSC's dress culture is European-casual** — nicer than American casual, less formal than legacy lines.

MSC for Me app is the operational hub. Daily program, specialty dining bookings, account balance, deck plans — download and log in before sailing.

Currency aboard: USD. **Service Charge (gratuity):** \$17/day standard (\$23 Yacht Club), effective May 11, 2026; verify with Tina whether pre-paid in your group rate.

Decide before you board. Run the [drink-calculator](#) on your real drinking pattern, the [budget-calculator](#) for the total-fare picture, and the [tipping-calculator](#) for Service Charge + cash tips — MSC mid-sail upgrades cost more per day and give you fewer days of usage. Tina knows what's bundled.

Getting to the ship — and getting home

Arrival: Friday recommended, Saturday required

Friday, April 23 — fly in. Same-day flights to a 3:30 PM all-aboard are risky. Pre-cruise hotel in Brickell, Downtown Miami, or Miami Beach gives you margin and lets you use Friday afternoon for South Beach, Wynwood, or Little Havana.

Saturday, April 24 — embarkation.

- **Terminal: MSC Miami Cruise Terminal** at PortMiami — the new MSC-built terminal that opened April 2025. *Different from where Royal Caribbean and Carnival board.* Confirm address with Tina.
- **MIA → MSC Terminal:** Uber/Lyft \$30–45, 20–30 min. Taxi flat-rate \$32.
- **FLL → MSC Terminal:** Uber/Lyft \$60–90, 45–60 min. Cheaper if split with another group member.
- **If driving:** Terminal AA garage **\$35/day** (~\$245/week, firsthand May 2026 — verify); offsite Miami long-term lots \$7–14/day with shuttle.
- **Embark window:** 11:30 AM – 3:30 PM. **All-aboard 4:00 PM.** Ship departs ~5:00 PM.
- **Online check-in via MSC for Me app** — complete it before arriving to skip a 20-minute queue.

Day 8 debark and the trip home

- **The night before:** bags in the hall by ~11 PM with color-coded tag indicating your debark group.
- **6:00 – 8:00 AM:** Breakfast at Il Mercato or La Brasserie.
- **7:00 AM:** Customs clearance complete. Self-disembarkation begins.
- **7:30 – 10:00 AM:** Walk-off in waves. All passengers off by 10:00 AM.

Carry-on with you: change of clothes for the journey home, all medications, passport, phone charger, valuables — anything you can’t lose if a checked bag is misrouted.

Getting from PortMiami to MIA. Uber/Lyft on Saturday afternoon, **\$30–45, 25–30 minutes.** The math just works; don’t overthink it.

Killing 4–6 hours before an evening flight:

- **Bayfront Park / Bayside Marketplace** — 10-min walk from the terminal. Outdoor shopping/dining waterfront.
- **Pérez Art Museum Miami (PAMM)** — 15-min walk. \$20 entry. Air-conditioned.
- **Brickell** — short Uber. Cuban coffee, lunch at a real restaurant, Uber to MIA when ready.

Airport-arrival timing.

Flight	Leave PortMiami by
Domestic, after 4 PM	1:30 PM
International, after 6 PM	2:30 PM

MIA TSA lines run 30–60 min during Saturday afternoon cruise return.

Areas of interest during the cruise

On the ship — World America spots worth knowing

- **The World Promenade** (Deck 8 aft) — the seven-deck outdoor walkway around the Y-shaped stern. Signature space. Bars and seating directly above the wake.
- **The World Galleria** (Decks 6–8 mid-ship) — three-deck atrium with an LED ceiling that changes scenes through the day. Orienting landmark if you get turned around.
- **Panorama Lounge** (above the Promenade, glass-walled Y-stern) — wake view from indoors; the right spot for a glass of wine after a port day.
- **Venom Drop @ The Spiral** — 11-deck dry slide; longest at sea. First hour after opening (typically 10 AM) has the shortest line.
- **Aurea Spa thermal suite** — sea-day intro rates appear; ~90 minutes is the right dose.
- **The Loft** — new comedy and karaoke lounge debuting on World America. Good group venue.
- **La Brasserie** (Deck 19) — 24/7 French-style casual. Crepes, fresh bread, lighter food. Quieter alternative to Il Mercato.
- **Masters of the Sea Pub** (Deck 7) — onboard microbrewery + pub food. Late-night fallback.

Sea-day priorities (Day 2 + Day 6)

1. **Sunrise coffee at the World Promenade** — the Y-stern wake view, full daylight by 7 AM.
2. **Climb the Venom Drop first thing** — empty in the first hour.
3. **Eataly at lunch** if you can't get a dinner reservation — pasta-making class some days.
4. **Aurea Spa thermal suite** — sea-day rates only appear sea-day mornings.
5. **Port talk for tomorrow's destination** — MSC schedules briefings; worth attending if it's your first time in Roatán or Cozumel.

Specialty dining picks

- **Eataly** (Deck 8) — the first Eataly at sea. Fresh pasta, wood-fired pizza, gelato. **The one to book on Day 1.**
- **Paxos** (Deck 8) — Greek seafood, open-air seating on the World Promenade.
- **Butcher's Cut** — steakhouse. Cagney's-equivalent for veterans of NCL.
- **Kaito Teppanyaki / Kaito Sushi Bar** — Japanese; the teppanyaki is the showy hibachi room.
- **HOLA! Tacos & Cantina** — modern Mexican.

Port-day picks (one each)

- **Roatán** — West Bay Beach via taxi (\$6–8/person each way) with offshore reef snorkeling. The day most cruisers come for.
- **Costa Maya** — the pool complex inside the gated port is free with your cruise card; or Chacchoben Mayan ruins (~\$50 indep / ~\$80 ship).
- **Cozumel** — Palancar Reef snorkel tour (~\$50 indep / ~\$95 ship). Two hours, calm water, the trip that converts non-snorkelers. *The Western Caribbean experience.*
- **Ocean Cay** — beach choice depends on crowd tolerance: South Beach (busy, has the Beach Shack), Bimini/Pineapple (calmer, west side), Ocean House Beach (longest walk from pier, least crowded).

The lighthouse show at Ocean Cay

Runs only on overnight or late-departure calls. Check your itinerary. If your sailing has the show, **Lighthouse Bay** (east side, next to the tower) is the seating area. The show: 15 minutes, free, the tower lights in red-and-white bands, then blue, then climbing gold; projections climb the cladding; Spanish guitar carries through the speakers. The reason to want an overnight call.

Where Denise sets the rhythm

- **Sailaway, Saturday April 24** — likely the World Promenade bar (Deck 8 aft) around 4:30 PM. Watch [Denise's Facebook page](#) for the exact location.
- **Group dinners** — venue and time per Denise's communications. The MDRs (Deck 5–6) seat groups easily; specialty venues need pre-booking with fixed party size.
- **Daily meeting point** — if Denise picks one, it'll be in her Facebook updates. The Loft and the Galleria are the natural gathering venues.

Photo spots worth knowing

- **World Promenade Deck 8 aft sailaway** — wake beneath the Y-stern, downtown Miami fading.
- **The Galleria LED ceiling** at sunset (scene changes 4:30–5:30 PM most days).
- **Roatán West Bay Beach** — white sand, turquoise water, reef offshore.
- **Cozumel Palancar Reef** from the snorkel boat — underwater camera worth it.
- **Ocean Cay striped lighthouse** at golden hour — Lighthouse Bay beach has the angle.

Need an at-home emergency handoff card? Separate one-page doc — ask Denise or download from [In the Wake](#). The full Voyage Pack is the unabridged companion document. Soli Deo Gloria.